

**SATYADHEESH**
सत्याधीश

UPSC DAILY DETAILED NOTES

Current Affairs · 1 October 2026**60**

NOTES

2

STORIES MERGED

GS1 · 4

GS2 · 24

GS3 · 32

PAPER MIX

CONTENTS**Every note, grouped by paper**

GS1	History · Society · Geography	4 notes
	History & Culture	2
	Geography	2
GS2	Polity · Governance · Social Justice · IR	24 notes
	Polity & Constitution	4
	Governance	5
	Social Justice	6
	International Relations	9
GS3	Economy · S&T · Environment · Security	32 notes
	Economy	12
	Agriculture	4
	Science & Technology	7
	Environment & Ecology	6
	Internal Security	3

HOW EACH NOTE READS

Why in news → facts to remember → a Mains question with keywords. Duplicate stories are merged.

SHORT ON TIME?

The 5-page **Brief** has the stories that matter most, plus a quiz. Same day, same notes.

History & Culture

2

MODERN INDIA & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128807

Madras High Court orders status report on removing caste appellations from Tamil Nadu roads

WHY IN NEWS The Madras High Court directed the Tamil Nadu government to submit a status report on removing caste-based names from public roads and streets.

- PLACE** | Madras High Court: Located in Chennai, Tamil Nadu
- FACT** | The court mandated a status report submission within four weeks of the October 1, 2026 order
- FACT** | The judicial scrutiny refers back to a 1978 Government Order regarding caste appellations

MAINS Q Discuss the constitutional implications of caste-based nomenclature in public infrastructure and its impact on the principle of equality and social dignity.

USE: Social Justice Constitutional Morality Caste Hierarchy Public Policy Equality

HERITAGE SITES, UNESCO & GI TAGS

P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128765

Union Ministry of Tourism approves ₹93.94 crore project to rejuvenate Maharaja Ajj Sarovar

WHY IN NEWS The Union Ministry of Tourism approved a ₹93.94 crore project to rejuvenate the Maharaja Ajj Sarovar in Punjab as a heritage destination under the Swadesh Darshan Scheme.

- SCHEME** | Swadesh Darshan Scheme: A central government initiative to develop and rejuvenate theme-based tourist destinations across India.
- PLACE** | Maharaja Ajj Sarovar: Located in Kharar, Sahibzada Ajit Singh Nagar (Punjab).
- FACT** | Project Budget: ₹93.94 crore approved for the rejuvenation of the 133-kanal site.

MAINS Q Discuss how the rejuvenation of heritage sites under the Swadesh Darshan Scheme contributes to the preservation of cultural identity and the promotion of sustainable tourism in India.

USE: Heritage Conservation Sustainable Tourism Swadesh Darshan Scheme Cultural Preservation Regional Development

Geography

2

GEOPHYSICAL PHENOMENA (EARTHQUAKES, CYCLONES, VOLCANOES)

P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128988

Karnataka faces -32% rainfall deficit as Bengaluru South sees -87% shortage

WHY IN NEWS The IMD reported a significant rainfall deficit in Karnataka, notably a -32% deficit statewide and an extreme -87% shortage in Bengaluru South, attributed to El Niño.

- FACT** | Karnataka rainfall deficit: -32% against a normal of 831.8 mm
- FACT** | Bengaluru South rainfall deficit: -87%
- S&T** | El Niño: A climate pattern characterized by the warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean
- BODY** | IMD: India Meteorological Department provides weather forecasting and climate services

MAINS Q Analyze how the increasing frequency of El Niño-induced rainfall deficits impacts the agricultural stability and water security of the Deccan Plateau.

USE: El Niño Rainfall Deficit Hydrological Stress Climate Variability Water Security

Northeast monsoon likely normal after 20% Southwest monsoon deficit, IMD Director-General says

WHY IN NEWS IMD Director-General Mrutyunjay Mohapatra projected a normal Northeast monsoon despite a 20% Southwest monsoon deficit, impacting rainfall distribution across India.

- FACT** | Southwest monsoon deficit recorded at 20% for the current season.
- PLACE** | Coastal Tamil Nadu and South India are primary recipients of Northeast monsoon rainfall.
- S&T** | Northeast monsoon typically begins in October and provides significant rainfall to the Coromandel Coast.

MAINS Q *Analyze the impact of monsoon variability on India's agricultural cycle and the importance of IMD's early warning systems in mitigating climate-induced risks.*

USE: Monsoon variability Hydrological cycle Climate resilience Agricultural planning Meteorological forecasting

Polity & Constitution

4

ELECTIONS, ECI & ELECTORAL REFORMS

P

3 REPORTS MERGED

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128888

ECI extends Andhra Pradesh house-to-house enumeration until July 24, 2026

WHY IN NEWS The Election Commission of India (ECI) extended the house-to-house enumeration for the Special Intensive Revision in Andhra Pradesh until July 2026 to ensure complete digitization of electoral rolls.

BODY | ECI: Constitutional body responsible for administering elections to Parliament and State Legislatures.

FACT | The Special Intensive Revision in Andhra Pradesh covers a base of 4.16 crore electors.

FACT | The final publication of the revised electoral roll is scheduled for October 3, 2024.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of accurate and digitized electoral rolls in ensuring the integrity of the democratic process in India.

USE: Electoral Integrity Digitization Constitutional Mandate Special Intensive Revision Demographic Accuracy

CONSTITUTION, AMENDMENTS & BASIC STRUCTURE

P

M

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129061

Andhra Pradesh High Court sets aside BC reservations exceeding 50% threshold in local bodies

WHY IN NEWS The Andhra Pradesh High Court struck down state government orders providing BC reservations in local bodies exceeding the 50% cap established by the Supreme Court.

CONSTITUTION | The 50% cap on reservations was established by the Supreme Court in the Indra Sawhney case (1992).

BODY | State Election Commission (SEC) is responsible for conducting elections to local bodies and municipalities.

FACT | The court set a deadline of October 1, 2026, for the conduct of local body elections.

MAINS Q Examine the constitutional validity of state-level reservation policies that exceed the 50% ceiling and their impact on the principle of equality.

USE: Judicial Review Social Justice Proportionality Reservation Policy Local Governance

ELECTIONS, ECI & ELECTORAL REFORMS

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1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128791

Karnataka voter deletions exceed 19% despite 91.30% mapping during Special Intensive Revision

WHY IN NEWS Karnataka reported a high deletion rate of over 19% of voters during the Special Intensive Revision despite high mapping percentages, raising concerns over electoral roll integrity.

BODY | Booth Level Officers (BLOs) are the primary field-level officials responsible for updating electoral rolls.

FACT | Karnataka Special Intensive Revision: 1.07 crore+ deletions recorded statewide.

FACT | Kodagu District: 98.67% mapping achieved with 13% deletion rate.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in maintaining accurate electoral rolls in India and suggest measures to ensure the integrity of the democratic process during intensive revisions.

USE: Electoral Roll Disenfranchisement Democracy Administrative Integrity Special Intensive Revision

Kerala High Court directs government to expedite pending cases against MPs and MLAs

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court directed the state government to expedite pending cases against legislators to ensure accountability and judicial efficiency.

BODY	District Judiciary Registrar: Responsible for administrative oversight of judicial processes at the district level.
ACT / BILL	Kerala Electronic Processes (Issuance, Service and Execution) Rules, 2025: Rules governing the use of digital tools like WhatsApp and videoconferencing for legal processes.
FACT	The directive mandates the deputing of two police officers per station specifically for process duty.

MAINS Q Discuss the institutional challenges in ensuring the timely execution of judicial processes against elected representatives and the role of technological integration in judicial accountability.

USE: Judicial Accountability Process Execution Digital Governance Legislative Oversight Administrative Efficiency

Governance

5

Court orders blocking services for motorists with ₹49,194.05 crore outstanding e-challans

WHY IN NEWS The High Court ordered the blocking of services for motorists with outstanding e-challans totaling ₹49,194.05 crore to improve revenue collection and road safety.

BODY	Parivahan: The national portal for vehicle registration and transport-related services in India.
POST	Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH): The central ministry responsible for road safety and infrastructure.
FACT	Outstanding e-challans amount to ₹49,194.05 crore as of the court's order.
FACT	Implementation deadline for the new SOP is October 28, 2025.

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of digital enforcement mechanisms like e-challans can enhance road safety and fiscal discipline while ensuring procedural fairness to motorists.

USE: Digital Governance Fiscal Discipline Road Safety Automated Enforcement Procedural Fairness

KSTDC and Muzrai Department sign 10-year agreement to manage Tirumala Tourist Complex

WHY IN NEWS The Muzrai Department and KSTDC signed a 10-year agreement to manage the Karnataka Tourist Complex at Tirumala to provide affordable pilgrim accommodation.

BODY	KSTDC: Karnataka State Tourism Development Corporation is a state-owned tourism body.
PLACE	Tirumala: Located in the Chittoor district of Andhra Pradesh, home to the Venkateswara Temple.
FACT	The agreement covers 364 rooms and 12 dormitories across five blocks.

MAINS Q Discuss how Public-Private-Partnership (PPP) models and inter-state cooperation can enhance the infrastructure and accessibility of religious tourism in India.

USE: Inter-state cooperation Public-Private-Partnership Religious tourism Infrastructure management Affordable housing

Modi says UPSC exams must test why youth want public service over office

WHY IN NEWS Prime Minister Narendra Modi addressed the centenary celebrations of the UPSC, emphasizing that recruitment exams should evaluate the underlying motivation of candidates to serve the public rather than seeking administr...

BODY	UPSC: A constitutional body established under Article 315 to conduct examinations for All India Services and Central Services.
POST	Narendra Modi: Prime Minister of India.
FACT	The UPSC celebrated its centenary in the year 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of shifting the focus of civil services recruitment from technical proficiency to public service orientation to enhance administrative accountability.

USE: Public Service Orientation Administrative Ethics Recruitment Reform Accountability Bureaucratic Integrity

Union Ministry of Tourism sanctions ₹55.74 crore for Arasavalli Sun God temple development

WHY IN NEWS The Union Ministry of Tourism sanctioned ₹55.74 crore for the development of the Arasavalli Sun God temple under the Swadesh Darshan 2.0 scheme to boost spiritual tourism.

SCHEME	Swadesh Darshan 2.0: A central government scheme aimed at developing theme-based tourist circuits and promoting spiritual tourism.
FACT	₹55.74 crore sanctioned for the Arasavalli Sun God temple development project.
PLACE	Arasavalli Sun God temple: A significant spiritual tourism site in India.

MAINS Q Discuss how the Swadesh Darshan 2.0 scheme aims to leverage India's cultural heritage to promote spiritual tourism and regional economic development.

USE: Spiritual Tourism Swadesh Darshan 2.0 Cultural Heritage Infrastructure Development Regional Connectivity

Supreme Court suggests linking unpaid e-challans to electricity bills to recover fines

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court suggested linking unpaid e-challans to electricity bills to address the massive backlog of unresolved traffic fines.

FACT	Traffic challans in India increased from 4.2 crore in 2021 to 9.6 crore in 2025.
FACT	As of 2026, 82% of all issued e-challans remain unpaid.
FACT	In 2025, only 8.6% of the 2.9 crore challans sent to courts were disposed of.
PLACE	Uttar Pradesh recorded the highest number of traffic violations at nearly 9 crore.

MAINS Q Discuss the institutional and technological challenges in enforcing traffic regulations and recovering penalties in India's rapidly urbanizing landscape.

USE: Judicial Oversight Revenue Recovery Digital Governance Regulatory Compliance Infrastructure Management

EDUCATION POLICY

P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129070

AP HRD Minister orders DSC 2.0 notification and 'Zero Dropout Mission' within a month

WHY IN NEWS Andhra Pradesh HRD Minister Nara Lokesh directed the issuance of the DSC 2.0 notification and the launch of a 'Zero Dropout Mission' to address school dropouts and faculty shortages.

BODY	APPSC: Andhra Pradesh Public Service Commission is the body responsible for state civil service recruitment.
FACT	The state aims to fill 1,523 vacant faculty posts to improve educational infrastructure.
FACT	The government plans to establish 125 autism centres as part of its inclusive education strategy.
PLACE	Andhra Pradesh: The state government is initiating the 'Zero Dropout Mission' and LEAP Schools.

MAINS Q Discuss the systemic challenges in ensuring universal primary education in India and evaluate the effectiveness of community-led 'Zero Dropout' missions in reducing school attrition.

USE: Inclusive Education Human Capital Development Community Participation Educational Infrastructure Retention Strategies

HEALTH POLICY & PUBLIC HEALTH

P

M

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129022

Karnataka demands price controls after FSDA finds drugs marked up 52.6 times cost

WHY IN NEWS Karnataka government demanded expanded price controls after the Food Safety and Drug Administration (FSDA) discovered medicine markups of up to 52.6 times the landing cost.

BODY	NPPA: National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority is the body responsible for fixing prices of essential medicines in India.
BODY	FSDA: Food Safety and Drug Administration is the state-level regulatory body for food and drug safety.
FACT	The FSDA verification drive identified 253 drugs with markups exceeding 50 times the cost.

MAINS Q Examine the institutional mechanisms for regulating pharmaceutical pricing in India and discuss the need for a robust transparency framework to prevent predatory markups.

USE: Price Ceiling Regulatory Oversight Out-of-pocket Expenditure Market Transparency Public Health Equity

EDUCATION POLICY

P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129010

Class 9 students to learn income tax liability in new NCERT social science book

WHY IN NEWS NCERT released a new Class 9 Social Science textbook integrating personal finance and income tax liability to enhance financial literacy among students.

BODY	NCERT: National Council for Educational Research and Training is the apex body for school curriculum development in India
FACT	The new Class 9 Social Science textbook contains 16 chapters integrating personal finance pillars
POST	Dinesh Prasad Saklani: Director of NCERT

MAINS Q Discuss how integrating financial literacy and tax awareness into the school curriculum can contribute to achieving the goals of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020.

USE: Financial Literacy Pedagogical Reform Civic Responsibility Fiscal Awareness National Education Policy

Keralam to draft Bill for Tribal University in Wayanad with ₹50 crore budget

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala government is drafting a Bill to establish a Tribal University in Wayanad to improve tribal gross enrolment ratios and focus on indigenous studies.

- PLACE** | Wayanad: A district in Kerala known for its significant tribal population.
- FACT** | ₹50 crore: Budget allocated in the Revised State Budget for 2026–27 for the Tribal University.
- POST** | V.D. Satheesan: Chief Minister of Kerala.

MAINS Q Discuss how specialized educational institutions for tribal communities can address the structural barriers to higher education and socio-economic integration for indigenous populations in India.

USE: Gross Enrolment Ratio Indigenous Studies Socio-economic Transformation Tribal Welfare Educational Equity

Telangana directs DEOs to conduct pilot external evaluations for Classes 6 and 9

WHY IN NEWS The Telangana School Education Department directed District Educational Officers (DEOs) to conduct pilot external evaluations for Classes 6 and 9 to assess summative assessments.

- FACT** | The pilot evaluation covers 33 districts in Telangana.
- FACT** | Summative Assessment 1 for the pilot is scheduled from October 1 to October 10.
- PLACE** | Class 6 pilot evaluation is limited to nine districts including Adilabad and Hyderabad.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of periodic external evaluations in improving the quality of primary and secondary education in India.

USE: Pedagogical assessment Learning outcomes Educational equity Standardized evaluation Pilot project

Kerala High Court allows 50 and 49-year-old couple to continue IVF treatment

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court allowed a couple aged 50 and 49 to continue IVF treatment, challenging the age limits prescribed under the Assisted Reproductive Technology (Regulation) Act, 2021.

- ACT / BILL** | Assisted Reproductive Technology (Regulation) Act, 2021: Regulates IVF and surrogacy in India.
- BODY** | Kerala State Art and Surrogacy Board: The state-level body overseeing reproductive technology regulations.
- FACT** | The couple in the case was aged 50 and 49 years respectively.

MAINS Q Discuss the ethical and legal implications of age-based restrictions in reproductive technologies and the role of judicial intervention in balancing individual rights with statutory regulations.

USE: Reproductive Autonomy Judicial Precedent Statutory Interpretation Bioethics Right to Health

International Relations

9

Piyush Goyal meets Jamieson Greer to discuss interim trade agreement amid US tariff changes

WHY IN NEWS Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer to negotiate an interim trade agreement amidst shifting U.S. tariff policies.

- POST** | Jamieson Greer: U.S. Trade Representative (USTR)
- FACT** | Meeting date: September 30, 2026
- FACT** | India's trade competitors in this context: ASEAN, China, and Bangladesh

MAINS Q Analyze the challenges India faces in securing favorable trade terms with the United States amidst fluctuating global tariff regimes and regional competition.

USE: Trade Liberalization Tariff Protectionism Bilateral Cooperation Trade Diplomacy Market Access

Russia warns NATO it will use entire arsenal including nuclear weapons over Kaliningrad blockade

WHY IN NEWS Russia issued a diplomatic memo to NATO threatening the use of its entire arsenal, including nuclear weapons, in response to potential blockades of the Kaliningrad exclave.

- PLACE** | Kaliningrad: A Russian exclave located on the Baltic Sea, bordering Poland and Lithuania.
- POST** | Mark Rutte: The current Secretary-General of NATO.
- FACT** | Russia's nuclear arsenal is the largest in the world, governed by various arms control treaties.

MAINS Q Analyze the implications of the escalating Russia-NATO tensions in the Baltic region on European security architecture and global nuclear non-proliferation norms.

USE: Nuclear Deterrence Exclave Collective Defense Geopolitical Friction Security Dilemma

Narendra Modi and Donald Trump had a productive telephone call reviewing bilateral ties, trade

WHY IN NEWS PM Modi and Donald Trump held a telephone call to review bilateral ties and trade amidst discussions on the Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act.

- FACT** | The Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act proposes tariffs of up to 100% on specific imports.
- POST** | S. Jaishankar serves as the External Affairs Minister of India.
- BODY** | The act targets countries importing Russian oil as a means of economic pressure.

MAINS Q Analyze how the proposed Lindsey Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act could impact India's strategic autonomy and its energy security goals.

USE: Strategic Autonomy Energy Security Trade Policy Geopolitical Pressure Tariff Regime

Trump signs White House Accord on Super Intelligence with Meta, Nvidia, and Google

WHY IN NEWS President Donald Trump signed the 'White House Accord on Super Intelligence' with major AI firms (Meta, Nvidia, Google, etc.) to establish voluntary guardrails and oversight for advanced AI development.

- S&T** | White House Accord on Super Intelligence: A voluntary pact between the US government and major AI firms for safety oversight.
- S&T** | OpenAI, xAI, and Anthropic: Key private entities involved in the development of Large Language Models and Super Intelligence.
- ACT / BILL** | Ban Artificial Superintelligence Act: A legislative proposal aimed at prohibiting the development of super-intelligent AI systems.

MAINS Q Discuss the necessity of multi-stakeholder governance frameworks in regulating Artificial Super Intelligence to balance technological innovation with global safety standards.

USE: Algorithmic accountability Technological sovereignty Safety guardrails Multi-stakeholder governance Regulatory framework

Netherlands Minister Silvio Erkens visits Bengaluru to explore agricultural collaboration with 18 businesses

WHY IN NEWS Netherlands Minister Silvio Erkens visited Bengaluru to explore agricultural collaboration with 18 businesses focusing on climate-resilient seeds and precision irrigation.

POST	Silvio Erkens: Minister for Food Security, Fisheries and Horticulture of the Netherlands
PLACE	Bengaluru: Host city for the agricultural collaboration discussions
FACT	18 businesses from the Netherlands participated in the delegation
S&T	AI and smartphones are identified as key tools for smallholder farmer support

MAINS Q Discuss how international agricultural collaborations can enhance India's climate-resilient farming and water management strategies for smallholder farmers.

USE: Climate-resilient agriculture Precision irrigation Smallholder farmers Technological leapfrogging Water management

Kumaraswamy requests Srirangapatna tourism hub development under Swadesh Darshan 2.0 scheme

WHY IN NEWS Union Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy requested the development of Srirangapatna as a tourism hub under the Swadesh Darshan 2.0 scheme to enhance heritage infrastructure.

SCHEME	Swadesh Darshan 2.0: A central government initiative to develop and promote theme-based tourist destinations across India.
PLACE	Srirangapatna: A historic city in Karnataka, significant for its association with Tipu Sultan and the Ranganathaswamy Temple.
POST	H.D. Kumaraswamy: Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting (as of October 2026).

MAINS Q Discuss how the Swadesh Darshan 2.0 scheme contributes to the preservation of cultural heritage while promoting sustainable tourism in India.

USE: Heritage Tourism Infrastructure Development Cultural Preservation Sustainable Tourism Swadesh Darshan 2.0

MSF warns \$28,000 annual cost limits access to Gilead's HIV prevention injection

WHY IN NEWS The FDA approval of lenacapavir, a breakthrough HIV prevention drug, highlights the tension between medical innovation and global healthcare equity.

S&T	Lenacapavir: A twice-yearly injectable drug developed by Gilead Sciences for HIV prevention.
BODY	FDA: The United States Food and Drug Administration approved lenacapavir in June 2025.
BODY	UNAIDS: Reported a funding drop to \$7.3 billion in 2025 for global HIV initiatives.
FACT	Gilead Sciences target: Providing lenacapavir for 3 million people through 2028.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges of balancing intellectual property rights with the need for affordable access to life-saving medicines in developing nations.

USE: Intellectual Property Rights Healthcare Equity Pharmaceutical Accessibility Global Health Governance Public-Private Partnership

The Kerala High Court ruled that a Pakistani national married to an Indian citizen

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court ruled that a Pakistani national married to an Indian citizen has no 'vested right' to a visa, upholding the Centre's sovereign authority over immigration.

POST | Justice Bechu Kurian Thomas: Presiding judge of the Kerala High Court in the visa ruling.

FACT | Visa suspension for Pakistani nationals: Valid until April 29, 2025.

BODY | Immigration: An exclusive sovereign function of the Union Government under the Constitution of India.

MAINS Q Discuss the balance between individual rights of foreign nationals married to Indian citizens and the State's sovereign right to regulate immigration for national security.

USE: Sovereign prerogative National security Immigration policy Judicial review Vested rights

Nirmala Sitharaman invites global investors to Chicago roundtable to highlight GIFT City

WHY IN NEWS Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman hosted a roundtable in Chicago to promote GIFT City as a global investment hub during her visit to the U.S.

PLACE | GIFT City (Gujarat International Finance Tecity) is India's first operational smart city and international financial services center.

FACT | GIFT City had 1,250 registered entities as of June 2026.

POST | Nirmala Sitharaman serves as the Union Minister of Finance.

BODY | The U.S.-India Strategic Partnership Forum is a platform for bilateral economic and strategic cooperation.

MAINS Q Discuss the role of Special Economic Zones (SEZs) and International Financial Services Centres (IFSCs) in attracting Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) and enhancing India's global economic standing.

USE: FDI IFSC Smart City Investment Hub Strategic Partnership

Economy

12

EMPLOYMENT & INCLUSIVE GROWTH

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M

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129196

Households without biometric Aadhaar authentication to receive only 5kg or 10kg cylinders

WHY IN NEWS The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas mandated that households lacking biometric Aadhaar authentication (BAA) will only receive 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices to ensure subsidy integrity.

- BODY** | Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL are the three major public sector oil marketing companies in India.
- FACT** | The mandate restricts households without BAA to 5kg or 10kg cylinders at market prices.
- POST** | The Union Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas oversees the distribution of LPG subsidies.

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of biometric authentication in Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) schemes balances the objective of subsidy leakage prevention with the challenge of digital exclusion.

USE: Direct Benefit Transfer Digital Exclusion Subsidy Leakage eKYC Public Distribution System

MONETARY POLICY, RBI & BANKING

P

M

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/128866

80% of Mumbaikars refuse 0.4% MDR on UPI payments above ₹2,000

WHY IN NEWS The Ministry of Finance notified a framework to introduce a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI payments above ₹2,000, sparking consumer resistance and merchant pushback.

- FACT** | MDR of 0.4% applies to person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI payments above ₹2,000 starting October 15, 2026
- FACT** | MDR is capped at ₹300 per transaction for payments of ₹75,000 and above
- FACT** | Maharashtra accounted for 9.84% of UPI transactions by volume as of April 2026
- BODY** | NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India) provides state-wise UPI transaction data

MAINS Q Discuss the economic implications of transitioning from a zero-MDR model to a fee-based structure for UPI payments on the digital economy and financial inclusion.

USE: Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) Digital Payments Financial Inclusion Transaction Costs UPI Framework

GROWTH, INFLATION & MACRO INDICATORS

P

M

1 Oct · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/128822

India's economy faces risks as crude oil prices jump 28.66% to \$116.04

WHY IN NEWS The Finance Ministry flagged risks to India's economy due to a 28.66% surge in crude oil prices in September and potential US-led trade restrictions on Russian crude.

- FACT** | India's crude oil basket price in September: \$116.04 per barrel
- FACT** | Real GDP growth rate in Q1 FY27: 7.8%
- FACT** | Indian crude basket composition: Sweet crude (Brent-based) and Sour crude (Oman and Dubai grades)
- FACT** | Manufacturing growth rate in Q1 FY27: 9.2%

MAINS Q Analyze how volatile global energy prices and geopolitical trade shifts impact India's fiscal stability and domestic inflation targets.

USE: Imported Inflation Energy Security Fiscal Risk Trade Volatility Supply Chain Resilience

India's external debt rose \$15.4 billion to \$778.2 billion by end-June

WHY IN NEWS RBI data revealed a rise in India's external debt to \$778.2 billion by June 2024, reflecting the country's evolving debt-to-GDP dynamics.

- FACT** | India's total external debt reached \$778.2 billion by June 2024.
- FACT** | India's debt-to-GDP ratio moderated to 20.8% as of June 2024.
- FACT** | August 2024 services trade exports were \$35.5 billion against \$18.9 billion imports.
- BODY** | The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the primary authority for monitoring external debt and debt-to-GDP ratios.

MAINS Q Analyze the factors influencing India's external debt dynamics and discuss the implications of a moderating debt-to-GDP ratio on India's macroeconomic stability.

USE: Debt-to-GDP ratio External debt Macroeconomic stability Current account Sovereign credit

India proposes \$25 billion pool to support Deep Tech startups and reduce foreign dependence

WHY IN NEWS India proposed a \$25 billion fund to support Deep Tech startups to reduce reliance on foreign technology, as highlighted by the IVCA-Venture Intelligence Bharat DeepTech Report 2026.

- FACT** | Proposed Deep Tech fund size: \$25 billion
- BODY** | IVCA: Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association
- FACT** | Total funding recorded between 2015 and July 2026: \$11.4 billion
- FACT** | Number of Deep Tech deals recorded by July 2026: 957

MAINS Q Discuss how fostering a robust Deep Tech ecosystem can enhance India's technological sovereignty and reduce its dependence on foreign intellectual property.

USE: Technological Sovereignty Deep Tech Venture Capital Capital Formation Import Substitution

11 start-ups to receive up to ₹50 lakh for climate-resilient healthcare and agriculture

WHY IN NEWS C-CAMP and Ashraya Hastha Trust announced a cohort of 11 start-ups to receive up to ₹50 lakh each to foster climate-resilient healthcare and agriculture innovations.

- BODY** | C-CAMP: Centre for Cellular and Molecular Platforms, a non-profit organization promoting biotechnology research.
- FACT** | Funding amount: Up to ₹50 lakh per selected start-up.
- FACT** | Announcement date: October 01, 2026.
- S&T** | Focus areas: Climate-resilient healthcare and agriculture technologies.

MAINS Q Discuss how fostering climate-resilient biotechnology start-ups can contribute to India's goals of food security and healthcare accessibility in the face of climate change.

USE: Climate-resilient Biotechnology Venture Capital Food Security Start-up Ecosystem

National PNG Drive 3.0 targets 50 lakh new connections and 40 lakh conversions

WHY IN NEWS The Union Government launched National PNG Drive 3.0 to accelerate the transition to piped natural gas (PNG) by targeting massive new connections and conversions by FY2027.

- BODY** | PNGRB: The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board is the statutory body regulating the natural gas sector in India.
- FACT** | National PNG Drive 3.0 targets 50 lakh new connections and 40 lakh conversions by FY2027.
- FACT** | Phase 2 of the drive (ending June 30, 2026) added 13.4 lakh billed connections and 15.3 lakh registrations.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of expanding the piped natural gas (PNG) network in India's transition towards a cleaner energy mix and its impact on urban infrastructure.

USE: Energy Transition Infrastructure Development Decarbonization Regulatory Framework Urbanization

Wedding gifts worth Rs 10 lakh exempt from tax under Section 56(2)(x)

WHY IN NEWS Clarification on tax exemptions for wedding gifts under Section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act highlights the distinction between personal gifts and taxable 'Income from Other Sources'.

- ACT / BILL** | Section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act deals with taxing gifts and assets received without consideration.
- FACT** | Exemption limit for wedding gifts is Rs 10 lakh.
- FACT** | Taxable threshold for non-relative gifts is Rs 50,000 in a financial year.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in curbing the use of high-value gifts as a means of informal wealth transfer and the role of the Income Tax Act in ensuring fiscal transparency.

USE: Income from Other Sources Fiscal Transparency Tax Evasion Wealth Transfer Compliance

NSE receives no-objection certificate to introduce corporate bond index futures contracts

WHY IN NEWS The NSE received a no-objection certificate to introduce corporate bond index futures contracts to enhance risk management in the debt market.

- BODY** | NSE: A leading stock exchange in India regulated by SEBI
- BODY** | RBI: The primary regulator of the Indian debt and banking markets
- FACT** | Total outstanding corporate bonds reached 61.05 trillion rupees as of August 2026
- S&T** | Futures contracts: Financial instruments that allow investors to buy/sell assets at a predetermined price on a future date

MAINS Q Discuss how the introduction of corporate bond index futures can enhance liquidity and risk management in India's deepening debt markets.

USE: Risk Management Capital Markets Liquidity Debt Instruments Financial Innovation

Data released on Wednesday showed personal loan outstanding at Rs 72.9 lakh crore

WHY IN NEWS The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) released data showing a significant surge in personal and gold loan outstandings, reflecting changing credit consumption patterns in India.

- FACT | Personal loan outstanding: Rs 72.9 lakh crore
- FACT | Gold loan growth: 83.2% reaching Rs 5.6 lakh crore
- FACT | Credit to services sector: Rs 63 lakh crore (24.3% growth)
- FACT | Credit to industry sector: Rs 45.8 lakh crore (18.2% growth)

MAINS Q Analyze the implications of the rapid growth in personal and gold loans on the stability of the Indian banking sector and the rising trend of household debt.

USE: Credit expansion Monetary stability Household debt Asset quality Credit lifecycle

Sebi allows companies to use audited results in DRHP until September 30

WHY IN NEWS SEBI has established a regulatory deadline of September 30 for companies with a March 31 fiscal year-end to use audited results in their Draft Red Herring Prospectus (DRHP).

- BODY | SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) is the primary regulator of the securities and commodity markets in India.
- FACT | India saw 34 IPOs in September raising ₹39,400 crore.
- FACT | The DRHP (Draft Red Herring Prospectus) is the preliminary registration document filed by companies intending to go public.

MAINS Q Discuss how regulatory frameworks and reporting deadlines influence the ease of doing business and capital formation in the Indian primary market.

USE: Capital Markets SEBI DRHP IPO Regulatory Compliance

Tamil Nadu's first booth-less toll plaza opens with multi-lane free flow system

WHY IN NEWS NHAI launched Tamil Nadu's first booth-less toll plaza at Paranur using a multi-lane free flow system to eliminate waiting times.

- BODY | NHAI: National Highways Authority of India is the nodal agency for highway development in India
- FACT | Paranur toll plaza capacity: 46,500 daily vehicles
- S&T | Multi-lane free flow system: Toll collection technology that allows vehicles to pass without stopping at physical booths
- PLACE | Paranur toll plaza is located on the Chennai - Tiruchi National Highway

MAINS Q Discuss how the transition to automated, booth-less tolling systems contributes to infrastructure efficiency and the 'Ease of Doing Business' in India.

USE: Infrastructure modernization Ease of Doing Business Automated tolling Logistical efficiency Digital infrastructure

MSP, PROCUREMENT, PDS & FOOD SECURITY P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129179

Revanth Reddy cabinet approves ₹2,500 crore annual Dearness Allowance installments

WHY IN NEWS The Telangana State Cabinet approved ₹2,500 crore for Dearness Allowance installments and initiated measures to mitigate El Niño-induced rainfall deficits.

- FACT** | Telangana recorded a 17% rainfall deficit due to El Niño impacts.
- FACT** | State peak power demand reached 19,892 MW.
- FACT** | Government committed to 7,800 MW of renewable energy projects.
- PLACE** | Koheda: Site for a new fruit market in Telangana.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges faced by agrarian states in managing climate-induced rainfall deficits and the role of renewable energy in ensuring power security.

USE: El Niño Renewable Energy Fiscal Federalism Climate Resilience Agrarian Distress

FOOD PROCESSING & SUPPLY CHAIN P M

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129023

Naidu, Sitharaman and Pawan Kalyan to launch ₹1 lakh-crore Global Horticulture Hub

WHY IN NEWS The launch of the ₹1 lakh-crore Global Horticulture Hub in Madanapalle aims to scale up India's horticultural production through a public-private partnership model.

- FACT** | The Global Horticulture Hub aims to double production to 435 lakh tonnes.
- SCHEME** | Purvodaya scheme: A state-level initiative providing ₹40,352 crore for the horticulture hub.
- PLACE** | Madanapalle: The designated location for the Global Horticulture Hub in Andhra Pradesh.
- FACT** | The project covers 5,869 villages and is intended to benefit 9.6 lakh farmers.

MAINS Q Discuss how public-private partnership models in large-scale agricultural infrastructure can enhance India's horticultural output and farmer incomes.

USE: Public-Private Partnership Value Chain Horticultural Infrastructure Investment Synergy Agri-Logistics

CROPPING PATTERNS & IRRIGATION P

1 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129003

TGNPDCL crosses 100 MW solar capacity under PM-KUSUM-A scheme for farmers' income

WHY IN NEWS TGNPDCL announced crossing 100 MW solar capacity under the PM-KUSUM-A scheme to provide farmers with additional income through grid-connected solar power.

- SCHEME** | PM-KUSUM: A central government scheme aimed at providing energy security and additional income to farmers through solar power generation.
- FACT** | TGNPDCL reached 100 MW solar capacity milestone on October 01, 2026.
- FACT** | Target capacity for TGNPDCL under PM-KUSUM-A is 300 MW.
- BODY** | TGNPDCL: Telangana Northern Power Distribution Company Limited.

MAINS Q Discuss how decentralized solar power initiatives like PM-KUSUM can alleviate rural poverty while simultaneously addressing India's renewable energy targets.

USE: Decentralized Renewable Energy Rural Livelihoods Energy Security Grid Integration Sustainable Agriculture

Telangana to launch common metro and bus pass on October 2, 2026

WHY IN NEWS The Telangana government announced a common metro and bus pass to integrate public transport modes and enhance urban mobility.

- FACT** | Launch date for the common metro and bus pass in Telangana is October 2, 2026
- BODY** | TGSRTC: Telangana State Road Transport Corporation is the state-run bus service provider
- BODY** | Hyderabad Metro Rail Ltd: The entity responsible for the operation of the Hyderabad Metro Rail

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of multi-modal public transport systems can enhance urban mobility and economic productivity in rapidly expanding Indian cities.

USE: Multi-modal integration Urban mobility Public transport Inter-agency coordination Last-mile connectivity

Science & Technology

7

Naidu, Chouhan to launch 3D Concrete Printing project for 177 houses in Guntur

WHY IN NEWS The launch of a 3D Concrete Printing pilot project in Guntur, Andhra Pradesh, to construct 177 houses for SC/ST categories under PMAY-G 2.0.

- S&T** | 3D Concrete Printing: An additive manufacturing process used to create structural elements by depositing layers of concrete.
- BODY** | CSIR-Central Building Research Institute (CBRI): A premier research body under the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research.
- SCHEME** | PMAY-G 2.0: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana – Gramin, a central scheme for providing housing to rural-poor households.
- FACT** | The pilot project targets the construction of 177 houses in the Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh.

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of additive manufacturing technologies like 3D concrete printing can revolutionize rural housing and infrastructure development in India.

USE: Additive Manufacturing PMAY-G 2.0 Infrastructure Innovation Rural Housing CSIR-CBRI

Adani Green to build world's largest single-location battery storage at Khavda, Gujarat

WHY IN NEWS Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL) expanded its Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) at Khavda, Gujarat, to 6.63 GWh, creating the world's largest single-location battery storage facility.

- FACT** | AGEL's Khavda BESS capacity: 6.63 GWh as of June 2026
- FACT** | India's total operational BESS capacity: 12.6 GWh
- S&T** | BESS technology used: Lithium-ion batteries integrated with Energy Management Systems (EMS)
- PLACE** | Location: Khavda, Gujarat (site of a 30 GW renewable energy plant)

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) in achieving India's goal of a reliable and dispatchable renewable energy grid.

USE: Renewable Energy Grid Stability Lithium-ion Battery Energy Management Systems Dispatchable Power

Indian team attoPION beats 700 proposals to win CERN Beamline for Schools competition

WHY IN NEWS The Indian team 'attoPION' won the 13th CERN Beamline for Schools competition by modeling pion charge exchange to assist the Deep Underground Neutrino Experiment (DUNE).

- S&T** | CERN: European Organization for Nuclear Research, headquartered in Switzerland and France.
- S&T** | DUNE: Deep Underground Neutrino Experiment, a major international physics project to study neutrino oscillations.
- S&T** | Pion charge exchange: A nuclear physics process where a pion changes its charge through interaction with a nucleus.
- BODY** | IIT-Bombay: Indian Institute of Technology Bombay, a premier public technical university.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of international scientific collaborations and competitions in fostering indigenous research capabilities and human resource development in India's high-energy physics sector.

USE: Human Capital Development Scientific Collaboration High-Energy Physics Knowledge Transfer Research Pedagogy

Google to withhold Gemini 4 Argon from public, releasing only to vetted experts

WHY IN NEWS Google announced a restricted release of its Gemini 4 Argon AI model to vetted experts and the US government to prevent cyber exploitation.

- S&T** | Gemini 4 Argon: A specialized AI model by Google designed for cybersecurity and software flaw identification.
- POST** | Sundar Pichai: CEO of Google and Alphabet Inc.
- FACT** | The model is restricted to vetted cybersecurity experts and the US government to mitigate hacking risks.

MAINS Q Discuss the ethical and security implications of restricting access to advanced AI models and the necessity of international cooperation in AI governance.

USE: AI Governance Cybersecurity Dual-use Technology Ethical AI Technological Sovereignty

Bihar cabinet approves ₹16,000 crore green hydrogen policy to create 12,000 jobs

WHY IN NEWS The Bihar Cabinet approved the 'Bihar Green Hydrogen Policy, 2026' to establish a production target of 1,00,000 tonnes of green hydrogen annually by 2031.

- FACT** | Bihar Green Hydrogen Policy target: 1,00,000 tonnes of green hydrogen annually by 2031
- FACT** | Total investment approved under the policy: ₹16,000 crore
- BODY** | BREDA (Bihar Renewable Energy Development Agency) is the nodal agency for the policy
- FACT** | Job creation target: 12,000 jobs

MAINS Q Examine how state-led green hydrogen policies can accelerate India's transition to a net-zero economy while addressing regional industrial development.

USE: Decarbonization Energy Transition Green Hydrogen Industrial Policy Net-Zero

Google, Meta and OpenAI sign White House Accord as FTC plans sweeping probe

WHY IN NEWS Major AI labs (Google, Meta, OpenAI, etc.) signed 'The White House Accord on Super Intelligence' while the FTC announced a probe into consumer protection issues.

S&T | The White House Accord on Super Intelligence involves voluntary commitments for AI safety and internal controls.

BODY | The Federal Trade Commission (FTC) is the US agency investigating consumer protection issues in AI.

FACT | The accord requires the establishment of empowered teams and external monitors for AI oversight.

MAINS Q Discuss the necessity of voluntary commitments versus mandatory regulatory frameworks in governing the development of Super Intelligence and ensuring consumer protection.

USE: Algorithmic accountability Regulatory oversight Super Intelligence Consumer protection Corporate governance

FTC investigates OpenAI and Anthropic over rogue agents and threats to humanity

WHY IN NEWS The US Federal Trade Commission (FTC) launched an investigation into OpenAI and Anthropic regarding 'rogue agents' and existential threats to humanity following a July 2024 security breach.

BODY | FTC: The Federal Trade Commission is the primary federal agency in the US responsible for consumer protection and antitrust enforcement.

S&T | Hugging Face: A major open-source platform and community for machine learning and AI model hosting.

S&T | Anthropic: The AI company responsible for the 'Claude' large language model.

S&T | OpenAI: The developer of the ChatGPT and DALL-E AI models.

MAINS Q Discuss the regulatory challenges in governing autonomous AI agents and the necessity of establishing liability frameworks for developers of high-risk artificial intelligence systems.

USE: Autonomous Agents AI Governance Algorithmic Accountability Cybersecurity Regulatory Oversight

Environment & Ecology

6

Supreme Court rules out nationwide firecracker ban, accepts limited relaxation for green crackers

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, opting for a conditional relaxation based on CSIR-NEERI's recommendations for 'green crackers' to balance cultural practices with air quality.

BODY | CSIR-NEERI: Council of Scientific and Industrial Research – National Environmental Engineering Research Institute

BODY | PESO: Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation regulates the manufacture and storage of explosives

FACT | Gen-2 green crackers reduce PM10 and PM2.5 pollution by 45%-60% compared to traditional crackers

PLACE | Delhi Government's Winter Action Plan 2026-27 was announced on September 29, 2024

MAINS Q Discuss the conflict between individual cultural rights and the collective right to a clean environment in the context of air pollution management in urban India.

USE: Precautionary Principle Right to Clean Environment Regulatory Compliance Pollution Mitigation Judicial Activism

Thrissur forest office stops PCK from using 4,261 hectares of lease-expired land

WHY IN NEWS The Divisional Forest Office in Thrissur issued a memo to stop the Plantation Corporation of Kerala Ltd. (PCK) from using 4,261 hectares of lease-expired forest land for pineapple cultivation.

ACT / BILL	Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980: State legislation for forest protection and conservation.
PLACE	Chalakudy and Vazhachal: Forest divisions located in the Thrissur district of Kerala.
FACT	4,261 hectares: The specific area of lease-expired forest land under dispute.

MAINS Q Discuss the conflict between large-scale commercial plantation activities and forest conservation goals in India. How can legal frameworks ensure sustainable land use?

USE: Forest Conservation Land Use Policy Monoculture Statutory Compliance Biodiversity Protection

Madras High Court orders Tamil Nadu to create SOP for elephants in religious festivals

WHY IN NEWS The Madras High Court directed the Tamil Nadu government to establish a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for the use of elephants in religious festivals to ensure animal welfare.

BODY	HR&CE: Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments department manages religious institutions in Tamil Nadu
FACT	The deadline for the Joint Working Group to submit the draft SOP is October 30, 2026
ENVIRONMENT	Elephants are listed under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972

MAINS Q Discuss the conflict between cultural practices and wildlife conservation laws in India. How can the state balance religious sentiments with animal welfare standards?

USE: Animal Welfare Wildlife Protection Act Cultural Heritage Standard Operating Procedure Biodiversity Conservation

Pollution, unregulated construction and climate change threaten Dal Lake's deteriorating ecosystem

WHY IN NEWS Dal Lake in Srinagar faces ecological collapse due to untreated sewage, plastic waste, and unregulated construction, threatening local livelihoods and biodiversity.

PLACE	Dal Lake is located in Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir
ENVIRONMENT	Pollution and weed growth are primary drivers of ecosystem degradation in Dal Lake
FACT	Untreated sewage and plastic waste are the primary pollutants identified in the lake's ecosystem

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and socio-economic impacts of urban pollution on freshwater bodies like Dal Lake and suggest measures for sustainable lake management.

USE: Ecosystem degradation Urban pollution Sustainable management Anthropogenic pressure Biodiversity loss

National River-Linking Project creates "ecological highways" for invasive species, ATREE researchers warn

WHY IN NEWS ATREE researchers warned that the National River-Linking Project could create 'ecological highways' facilitating the spread of invasive species across river basins.

FACT | National River-Linking Project aims to redistribute 174 billion cubic metres of water.

FACT | The project proposes to generate 34,000 MW of power through its infrastructure.

FACT | The project involves linking 37 river basins using 30 distinct links.

ENVIRONMENT | Invasive species migration via 'ecological highways' poses a risk to endemic biodiversity.

MAINS Q Examine the ecological risks associated with large-scale river-linking projects in India and suggest measures to mitigate the spread of invasive species.

USE: Endemic biodiversity Ecological highways Invasive species River-linking Habitat fragmentation

IIT Delhi records poor AQI of 207 as ICAR detects 19 stubble-burning events

WHY IN NEWS IIT Delhi recorded a 'poor' AQI of 207 as ICAR detected 19 stubble-burning events across six states, highlighting the seasonal air quality crisis.

FACT | IIT Delhi recorded a 'poor' AQI of 207 on the reported Wednesday.

FACT | ICAR detected 114 residue-burning events between September 15 and September 30.

BODY | ICAR-Indian Agricultural Research Institute is the body monitoring stubble-burning events.

PLACE | Safdarjung, Palam, Lodi Road, The Ridge, and Ayanagar are key monitoring stations in Delhi.

MAINS Q Discuss the multi-dimensional challenges in curbing stubble burning and suggest measures to mitigate the seasonal air quality crisis in the Indo-Gangetic Plain.

USE: Air Quality Index (AQI) Stubble Burning Indo-Gangetic Plain Crop Residue Management Ambient Air Pollution

Internal Security

3

Civil Aviation Ministry approves full-body scanners for 8 major Indian airports

WHY IN NEWS The Civil Aviation Ministry approved full-body scanners for 8 major Indian airports to enhance aviation security while developing privacy-preserving algorithms.

BODY | Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS): The nodal agency for aviation security in India.

FACT | 8 major airports approved for full-body scanners: Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Kochi, and Ahmedabad.

S&T | Picture-agnostic algorithms: AI-driven security protocols designed to identify threats without storing identifiable personal images.

MAINS Q Discuss the balance between enhancing national security through advanced surveillance technologies and upholding the individual right to privacy in public infrastructure.

USE: Aviation Security Right to Privacy Algorithmic Transparency Public Safety Technological Integration

Supreme Court sets aside Sambhal detention order, imposes ₹10 lakh costs on State

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court set aside a preventive detention order under the National Security Act (NSA) in Sambhal, UP, emphasizing that extra-judicial confessions cannot be the sole basis for detention.

ACT / BILL	National Security Act (NSA), 1980: Provides for preventive detention of individuals to prevent them from acting against state security.
PLACE	Sambhal: A district in the state of Uttar Pradesh, India.
FACT	The Supreme Court imposed a fine of ₹10 lakh on the State of Uttar Pradesh for procedural lapses.

MAINS Q Examine the constitutional safeguards against the arbitrary use of preventive detention laws in India and the role of the judiciary in upholding personal liberty.

USE: Preventive detention Personal liberty Extra-judicial confession Judicial review National Security Act

63% of cybercrime victims dissatisfied with police handling, report reveals

WHY IN NEWS The Status of Policing in India Report 2026 highlights a significant trust deficit, with 63% of cybercrime victims expressing dissatisfaction with police handling.

FACT	63% of cybercrime victims reported dissatisfaction with police handling in the 2026 report.
FACT	14% of cybercrime victims waited over four hours for assistance at police stations.
FACT	Confidence levels drop to 43% specifically during the investigation stage of cybercrime.
BODY	Lokniti-CSDS and Common Cause are the bodies responsible for the Status of Policing in India Report 2026.

MAINS Q Analyze the institutional and structural bottlenecks in the Indian police force that hinder effective victim-centric handling of cybercrimes.

USE: Victim-centric policing Cyber-forensics Institutional trust Police reform Digital crime



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